Wiscasset Select Board, Tax Assessors & Overseers of the Poor

8/18/2026 - Minutes

1. Call The Meeting To Order

   Members present: Chair Alissa Eason, Pam Dunning, Heather Jones, Cassaundra Rose, Sarah Whitfield, and Town Manager Dennis Simmons

2. Pledge Of Allegiance

3. Consent Agenda Items

   Pam Dunning moved to approve the Consent Agenda for August 18, 2026. Vote 5-0-0.

4. Public Hearing

   Pam Dunning moved to open the public hearing at 6:04 p.m. Vote 5-0-0.

   The referendum on the September 1, 2026 ballot is to determine whether or not to accept a grant and loan that has been offered for the sewer plant relocation. The package includes a $1,000,000 grant and a $9,000,000 loan at a low interest rate to assist the Town in its search for a new location . Dennis Simmons said if turned down, it may be difficult to obtain such a grant/loan combination in the future. Sarah Whitfield pointed out that the State will not provide any funding for a seawall for the plant at its present location. William Sutter referred to the Olver report and spoke in favor of leaving the sewer plant at its present location and applying for other grants to cover the necessary costs. Others speaking for or against accepting the grant/loan funding included James Kochan, Jim Crowley, Kim Dolce, Ed Polewarczyk and Economic Development Director Aaron Chrowstowsky.

   Ed Polewarczyk asked why the school budget should be approved when compared to a school of the same size which has 22 teachers compared to Wiscasset which has 49 teachers. School Superintendent Dr. Kim Andersson spoke in favor of approving the school budget citing the improved performance and growth in literacy and asked anyone who had questions to contact her.

5. Public Comment

   None

6. Department Head Or Committee Chair

   Heather Jones commented on the great job the Public Works Department had done refinishing and moving the James Weldon Johnson Memorial Bench to the Creamery Pier.

7. New Business

   a. Maine EMS Municipal Resolution: Emergency Medical Services Transport Plan.

   Pam Dunning moved to adopt the Municipal Resolution: Emergency Medical Services Transport Plan, designating Wiscasset Emergency Medical Services as the primary provider of transporting emergency medical services within the Town through a directly managed municipal EMS department, and authorize its execution, public posting, and submission to Maine EMS as required by 30 MRSA § 3172. Vote 5-0-0.

b. Ordinance Review Committee Ordinance Amendments (Selectman Eason)

Alissa Eason said the Ordinance Review Committee has five members, a quorum is four members, and the committee has difficulty meeting when a quorum is not present. She asked what value the committee offers the town.

Aaron Chrostowsky said the town had staff that could perform the duties of the ORC. Dennis Simmons suggested that the ORC was not needed. Alissa Eason said that with a planner and Economic Developer on staff perhaps the Ordinance Review Committee was not needed. Others spoke on the possibility of eliminating the committee. Dennis Simmons will present alternatives to the select board at the next meeting.

c. Fire Department Cost Recovery Ordinance

Dennis Simmons said the purpose of the proposed ordinance was to recover the Fire Department's cost of responding to repeated false alarms and calls that insurance would pay for.

d. Data Center Moratorium Ordinance (Selectman Jones)

Heather Jones recommended an 180-day moratorium, which could be renewed, to educate the board and town on a data center. The six-month moratorium would give the Planning Board an opportunity to do research. Sarah Witfield said all departments, not just the Planning Board, would be involved in the research. Dennis Simmons said the board had 90 days to decide on the wording of moratorium. Sarah Whitfield said no decisions or commitments had been made, and a moratorium would give the town time to research all aspects of a data center. Ed Polewarczyk questioned how the Planning Board would be able to make a recommendation when it would not have adequate information. Sarah Whitfield said that all departments would be involved in the research and the town would collaborate with other towns in its research. Simmons will prepare the wording for the moratorium for the next meeting.

e. Authorization to Use Funds from the Officer Reimbursement Special Revenue Account

Cassaundra Rose moved to authorize the expenditure of funds from the Officer Reimbursement Special Revenue Account to help cover costs associated with training the Town's new police officer at the Maine Criminal Justice Academy. Vote 5-0-0.

8. Town Manager's Report

Simmons reported that the dangerous building on Lee Street has been sold The Town has recovered $15,472 for legal fees, back taxes and clean-up fees.

Simmons said that there had been a fire that day at the Transfer Station. There were no injuries or damage.

9. Adjourn

Pam Dunning moved to adjourn the meeting at 7:38 p.m. Vote 5-0-0.